

breakdown. In major developed nations, it has been seen that a major amount of carbon footprint emission takes place far away from the end consumers. The world's biggest kiwifruit exporter, Zespri International, says that each 1kg of its New Zealand-grown green crop eaten in Europe generates the equivalent of 1.74kg of carbon dioxide in greenhouse gases – transportation across the globe and storage being reasons for the huge amount of CO₂ being produced.

Hope you've understood now why the calculation is such a tedious process. The more we buy, the bigger is our carbon footprint. Even a Google search produces CO₂

But why should we be bothered about carbon footprint? Did you notice the floods in more than seven states in India and drought in the others? And the floods in China and Russia? Did you ever see so many natural disasters in a single year in the past? The numbers continue to rise. One of the main reasons being high and reckless consumption of fossil fuel.

We'll now get to the interesting part: finding out your carbon footprint and knowing how quickly you're killing Mother Earth every time you take a flight or eat a kiwi.

Let's do the math

We all like the easy way out so let's start by going online to help you calculate your carbon footprint. There are many free calculators available and here are three of those that you'll find useful:

► **footprintnetwork.org**

<http://dgit.in/NwuIcv>

First in our list of online calculators is footprintnetwork.org. This is a site dedicated to educating people on their carbon footprint. It supports specific nations (including India, and also supports Hindi). The calculator asks you to select your country of residence and then calculates your carbon footprint based on a set of questions. The good thing about the system is that after calculating and comparing your footprint with your country, the world average and the highest carbon contributors, it tells you ways to reduce your footprint in a “do-able” manner.

► **ICICI Bank footprint calculator**

<http://dgit.in/S879Zu>

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